consumers. For this dataset, the consumers and producers might reach an agreement like this:

- The goal of sharing this dataset is to enable consumers to inject insights from the actor and role combination into other services. These might be other data products or not.
- The datasets are intended to be used together, using the standard combination mechanism of the common actor identifier to join, as is common at Messflix.
- Since the data is to be used across a wide variety of services, the goal is to have it available publicly, including the actor names, which should be fine with the security level.
- Since a lot of consumers want to analyze data historically, the data will be available with a backfill of three years.

In this agreement, we can spot a lot of collaboration and intention of usage by the consumers. This agreement helps the data product owner John Doe design the data products well from the start. It also prevents him from including unnecessary datasets. The only way to create such an agreement is for John and his consumer to get into a room and talk, before or while he creates the data product, not after.

Let’s now take a look at how Messflix as a company could help to implement such data contracts and sharing agreements across the data mesh.

5.7.2 Implementing data contracts and sharing agreements

Data contracts and sharing agreements, like the two outlined in the preceding section, can seem daunting to implement. They need to be stored somewhere, possibly have an automatic way of checking them, and must be up-to-date.

Therefore, we recommend a practical step-by-step approach. In our eyes, the most important part to get started is to kick off the discussions between data producers and consumers. On the other side, we warn you to not let a contract-like agreement kill your early data mesh seeds.